



R.C. Bhargava, Chairman, Maruti Suzuki India Ltd

back, why and how it happened. And, is there anything we can learn from these 40 years of partnering with Japan? And the experience of Maruti that can help us, going forward, in achieving the Prime Minister's [Narendra Modi's] vision for 20-25 years?

We all know that the coming of Maruti, in many ways, has changed the face of India—the cities look different, the roads look different, the kind of people who are driving cars are different. We never saw [so many] women who drive cars 20-30 years ago before Maruti came. Hardly any lady would want to venture out in an Ambassador on her own. This [the coming of Maruti] also gave them an opportunity to join the workforce more easily because going in a bus was never a good option for most ladies. A lot of entrepreneurs came up because they had the ability of low-cost transport. We got a lot of support for our plant in Gujarat when Mr Modi was the Chief



► The company launches the Maruti 1000—a three-box car that is effectively India's first contemporary sedan

► By this year, Maruti starts manufacturing more than 65 per cent of its components in India



► Suzuki Motor Corporation increases its stake in the company to 50 per cent. In the next two years, Maruti Udyog launches Zen (1993) and Esteem (1994)

1990

1991

1992